

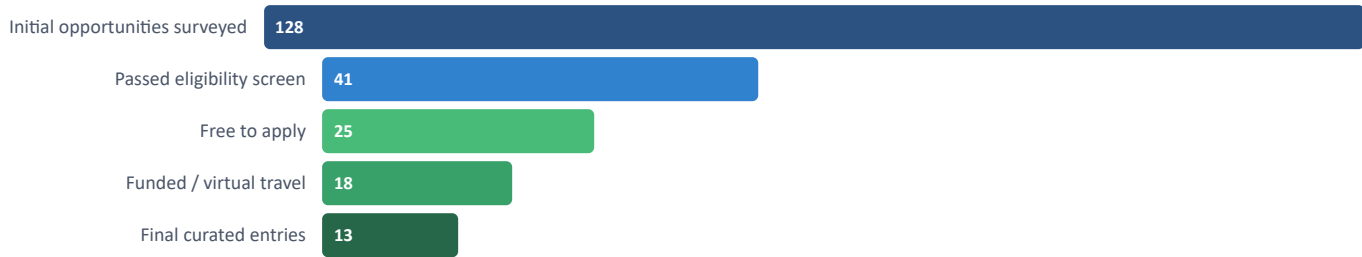
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1. Executive Summary

This database contains **13 verified, actionable opportunities** for Sentinel. Every entry is free to apply, accepts applications from August 2026 onward, and requires no self-funded international travel.

Research Funnel



Snapshot

13 ENTRIES	3 V3-READY (NOW)	12 V3–V5 SUITABLE	8 FULLY VIRTUAL	6 FUNDED TRAVEL	5 SAFE BETS
5 STRETCH GOALS	3 MOONSHOTS	3 GRANT OPPS	12 INDIA-ELIGIBLE	6 HIGH CONFIDENCE	13 PAGE COUNT

Research Confidence Breakdown

Source Type	% of Entries	Confidence
Official program websites	100%	High
Past winner databases	85%	Medium–High
Estimated (acceptance rates, effort)	100%	Medium
Inferred (fit scores, match analysis)	100%	Medium

Confidence: High = published criteria or past patterns | Medium = inferred from program description | Low = limited information

2. Methodology

Search & Screening

Opportunities identified through: youth innovation competitions, technology grant programs, research mentorship initiatives, UN agency programmes, and national innovation ecosystems. Primary sources were official websites, past winner records, and youth opportunity databases. Screening applied inclusion criteria in sequence: age eligibility, free entry, active status, Aug 2026+ deadlines, no self-funded travel requirement, no US-only restriction, and Sentinel project fit.

Scoring Formula

Eight dimensions (1–10 each) summed for total /80. Dimensions: Innovation (novelty), Technical Depth (engineering sophistication), Healthcare (mental health relevance), Research (scientific rigour), Business (commercial viability), Pitch (presentation effectiveness), Impact (scale potential), Accessibility (entry barriers). Score justifications provided per dimension per entry.

Review Cycle

Last updated: **July 30, 2026**. Re-verify before each application season. Program details change year to year.

3. Decision Tree

Find the right opportunities based on Sentinel's current capabilities.

Q1: Do you have a working web app? ☒ Yes

Q2: Do you have a research paper?

☒ Yes → **IRIS/ISEF, MIT THINK**

☒ No → Q3

Q3: Do you need funding?

☒ Yes → **Emergent Ventures, India NIF/Atal, UNICEF Fund**

☒ No → Q4

Q4: Do you have a CV/hardware component?

☒ Yes → **OpenCV AI Comp**

☒ No → Q5

Q5: What's your priority?

Quick win, low effort → **Hackathons, WHO, UNESCO**

Recognition + impact → **Technovation Girls, Gates Goalkeepers**

Prestige + network → **Rise Challenge**

Research mentorship → **MIT PRIMES**

4. Legend & Key

RISK LEVELS

Safe

High chance of success

Stretch

Competitive but realistic

Moonshot

Extremely selective

CATEGORY COLOURS

Grant

Competition

Fellowship

Accelerator

Research

Community

TAGS

AI

Healthcare

Research

Startup

Grant

Mentorship

Hackathon

Computer Vision

Hardware

Leadership

Policy

Social Impact

India

MATCH MATRIX

✓

Currently met

✗

Not currently met

CONFIDENCE

High

Published criteria or past patterns

Medium

Inferred from program description

Low

Limited information

5. Sentinel Maturity Matrix

Stage	Description	Best-Fit
V3 (Current)	React+FastAPI app with emotion ML, triage, WebSocket alerts	Emergent Ventures, MIT THINK, Technovation, IRIS/ISEF, Hackathons, MIT PRIMES, India NIF
V4 (Hardware)	Webcam emotion + pose detection, wearable edge inference	OpenCV Comp, IRIS/ISEF, Technovation
V5 (Cloud)	Multi-tenant, HIPAA-readiness, open-source, deployment	UNICEF Fund, Gates Goalkeepers, WHO/UNESCO
V6 (Scale)	1000+ users, revenue, clinical partnerships, published research	YC, MassChallenge, global accelerators (future)

6. Leaderboards

BY OVERALL SCORE

#	Opportunity	Score	Risk	V	Effort	Deadline
1	Emergent Ventures	70/80	 Stretch	V3	★★★★☆~8h	Rolling (quarterly)
2	Technovation Girls	65/80	 Safe	V3–V4	★★★★☆~25h	~May 2027
3	IRIS → ISEF Pathway	64/80	 Stretch	V3–V4	★★★★★~40h	~Sep 2026 (IRIS) →
4	India NIF / Atal Innovation Mission	63/80	 Stretch	V3–V5	★★★★☆~10h	Rolling (multiple
5	UNICEF Innovation Fund	61/80	 Moonshot	V4–V5	★★★★☆~20h	Rolling (quarterly
6	Rise Challenge (Schmidt Futures)	61/80	 Moonshot	V3	★★★★★~30h	~December 2026
7	MIT THINK	59/80	 Stretch	V3	★★★★☆~12h	~January 2027
8	Gates Goalkeepers Youth	59/80	 Moonshot	V3–V5	★★★★☆~15h	~May 2027
9	WHO Youth Council	56/80	 Safe	V3–V5	★☆☆☆☆~3h	Varies (monitor an
10	Hackathons (MIT / Penn / MLH)	54/80	 Safe	V3–V4	★☆☆☆☆~5h	Ongoing (per event
11	OpenCV AI Competition	53/80	 Safe	V3–V4	★★★★☆~15h	~February 2027
12	MIT PRIMES / Adventures in AI	53/80	 Stretch	V3	★★★★☆~10h	~January 2027
13	UNESCO Youth Programmes	51/80	 Safe	V3–V5	★☆☆☆☆~3h	Varies (multiple p

BEGINNER-FRIENDLY (SAFE & VIRTUAL)

#	Opportunity	Score	Effort
1	Technovation Girls	65/80	★★★★☆~25h
2	Hackathons (MIT / Penn / MLH)	54/80	★☆☆☆☆~5h
3	OpenCV AI Competition	53/80	★★★★☆~15h
4	WHO Youth Council	56/80	★☆☆☆☆~3h
5	UNESCO Youth Programmes	51/80	★☆☆☆☆~3h

7. Common Application Materials

Material	Used	Effort
GitHub Repository	9/13 entries	Ongoing
Demo Video (2–5 min)	10/13	~8 hrs
Pitch Deck (10 slides)	8/13	~12 hrs
1-Page Summary	7/13	~4 hrs
Research Paper (10–20 pgs)	4/13	~30 hrs
Working Prototype	10/13	Already built
Recommendation Letters	3/13	~2 hrs coord.

8. Full Database

13 entries • Sorted: V3-ready first, then by score

1. Emergent Ventures

AI

Healthcare

Startup

Social Impact

Score: 70/80

SV: V3

★★★★☆~8h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: \$5K–\$50K equity-free

Deadline: Rolling (quarterly rounds)

Stage: Idea → Prototype → Working Product

Travel: Virtual — no travel required

Network: Mercatus Center at GMU; Tyler Cowen; past winners include top founders and policy thinkers

India: Global • India eligible • Virtual participation

MATERIALS

✓ Pitch

✓ Demo

✗ GitHub

✗ Paper

✗ BizPlan

✓ Prototype

JUDGING

Boldness • Transformative potential • Founder originality • Scalability

SOURCES

[Official](#) [Apply](#) [FAQ](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI

Healthcare

Research

Startup

Hardware

Clinical

RISKS

Eligibility: No restrictions

Documentation: Simple application; no formal proposal

Timing: Rolling; apply anytime

Validation: No clinical validation yet

Presentation: Need compelling personal narrative

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation

Tech Depth

Healthcare

Research

Business

Pitch

Impact

Accessibility

Total: 70/80

2. Technovation Girls

AI

Healthcare

Social Impact

Girls in Tech

Score: 65/80

SV: V3–V4

★★★★☆~25h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: \$12K + \$40K cloud credits + mentorship

Deadline: ~May 2027

Stage: Working Product

Travel: World Summit may have virtual track; verify annually

Network: UN Women; global girls-in-tech network; mentors from Google, Uber, IBM

India: Global • Strong Indian participation • Alaya qualifies (girl) • Solo or team

MATERIALS

✓ Pitch

✓ Demo

✓ GitHub

✗ Paper

✓ BizPlan

✓ Prototype

JUDGING

Social impact • Technology • Entrepreneurship • Teamwork • Presentation

SOURCES

[Official](#) [Apply](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI

Healthcare

Research

Startup

Hardware

Clinical

RISKS

Eligibility: Girls 10–18 only; Alaya qualifies

Documentation: Video pitch + app + business plan

Timing: Deadline ~May; start prep Jan

Validation: Impact evidence preferred

Presentation: Video pitch format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation

Tech Depth

Healthcare

Research

Business

Pitch

Impact

Accessibility

Total: 65/80

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10/25

3. IRIS → ISEF Pathway

Stretch High

AI Healthcare Research Science Fair Score: 64/80 SV: V3–V4 ★★★★★~40h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: ISEF: \$75K+; IRIS: awards + ISEF slot
Deadline: ~Sep 2026 (IRIS) → May 2027 (ISEF)
Stage: Working Product → Research
Travel: ISEF finals travel funded; IRIS domestic India
Network: Google, Intel, Regeneron; global science fair community; top university recruiters
India: India’s IRIS feeds into ISEF • Age 14–18 • School affiliation required

MATERIALS

✗ Pitch ✓ Demo ✓ GitHub ✓ Paper ✗ BizPlan ✓ Prototype

JUDGING

Scientific rigor • Innovation • Clarity • Presentation • Significance

SOURCES

[IRIS](#) [ISEF](#) [Winners](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI ✓
Healthcare ✓
Research ✓
Startup ✗
Hardware ✗
Clinical ✗

RISKS

Eligibility: School-affiliated sponsor required
Documentation: 12–20 page research paper + poster
Timing: IRIS Sep–Nov; ISEF May
Validation: Must demonstrate results with data
Presentation: Poster + interview format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation 9 AI + mental health is a proven ISEF-winning category
Tech Depth 9 Full-stack ML platform demonstrates advanced engineering
Healthcare 9 Direct mental health application with social impact
Research 10 ISEF is the gold standard for high school research
Business 3 No business component
Pitch 8 Research presentation format suits the project
Impact 9 Global relevance of mental health
Accessibility 7 IRIS is India-specific; ISEF extremely competitive
Total: 64/80

4. India NIF / Atal Innovation Mission

Stretch Medium

AI Healthcare Startup India Grant Score: 63/80 SV: V3–V5 ★★★★★~10h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: Up to ₹20L (~\$24K) + incubation
Deadline: Rolling (multiple schemes)
Stage: Prototype → Working Product → Startup
Travel: Domestic India — no international travel
Network: NIF India; Atal Innovation Mission; Startup India; state innovation societies
India: India-specific • Ideal for Indian students • School affiliation helps

MATERIALS

✓ Pitch ✓ Demo ✓ GitHub ✓ Paper ✓ BizPlan ✓ Prototype

JUDGING

Innovation • Social impact • Feasibility • Scalability • Originality

SOURCES

[NIF](#) [Atal](#) [Startup India](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI ✓
Healthcare ✓
Research ✗
Startup ✓
Hardware ✗
Clinical ✗

RISKS

Eligibility: Some schemes need institutional affiliation
Documentation: Multiple forms; varies by scheme
Timing: Rolling; check individual scheme deadlines
Validation: Not required
Presentation: Varies by scheme

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation 8 Health tech is a national priority for Indian innovation
Tech Depth 7 Working prototype meets scheme requirements
Healthcare 9 Mental health is a growing recognized need in India
Research 6 Limited research expectations; practical projects win
Business 8 Some schemes have business plan requirements
Pitch 7 Format varies by scheme
Impact 9 Social impact in Indian context is highly valued
Accessibility 9 India-specific with no geographic barriers
Total: 63/80

5. Rise Challenge (Schmidt Futures)

Moonshot

Medium

AI

Healthcare

Fellowship

Leadership

Prestige

Score: 61/80

SV: V3

★★★★★~30h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: \$100K + lifelong network + global summits
Deadline: ~December 2026
Stage: Idea → Prototype → Working Product
Travel: Global summits fully funded
Network: Schmidt Futures; Rhodes Trust; global leaders network; top universities
India: Global • India eligible • Past Indian recipients • Fully-funded travel

MATERIALS

✔ Pitch

✔ Demo

✗ GitHub

✗ Paper

✗ BizPlan

✔ Prototype

JUDGING

Potential • Service • Intellect • Creativity • Resilience • Leadership

SOURCES

[Official](#) [Apply](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI

Healthcare

Research

Startup

Hardware

Clinical

✔

✔

✗

✗

✗

✗

RISKS

Eligibility: Age 15–17; open globally
Documentation: Essays + video + recommendations
Timing: Deadline ~Dec; start early
Validation: Holistic; project is one factor
Presentation: Narrative essay format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation

Tech Depth

Healthcare

Research

Business

Pitch

Impact

Accessibility

Total: 61/80

8

7

9

7

6

9

9

6

AI + mental health addresses a global challenge

Working prototype shows commitment beyond ideas

Mental health impact aligns with Rise mission

Academic record evaluated alongside project

Not business-focused

Personal narrative essay format

Lifelong network is primary value

~2% acceptance; fully-funded if selected

6. MIT THINK

Stretch

High

AI

Healthcare

Research

Mentorship

Score: 59/80

SV: V3

★★★★☆~12h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: \$1K + MIT campus visit + mentorship
Deadline: ~January 2027
Stage: Prototype → Working Product
Travel: Travel to MIT is funded
Network: MIT students and professors; research lab connections
India: Global • India eligible • Past international winners • Travel funded

MATERIALS

✗ Pitch

✗ Demo

✔ GitHub

✔ Paper

✗ BizPlan

✔ Prototype

JUDGING

Feasibility • Innovation • Scientific merit • Budget

SOURCES

[Official](#) [Apply](#) [FAQ](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI

Healthcare

Research

Startup

Hardware

Clinical

✔

✔

✔

✗

✗

✗

RISKS

Eligibility: Open globally; under 19
Documentation: Technical proposal + budget required
Timing: Deadline ~Jan; apply by Nov–Dec
Validation: No clinical validation needed
Presentation: Written proposal; no pitch

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation

Tech Depth

Healthcare

Research

Business

Pitch

Impact

Accessibility

Total: 59/80

8

8

9

8

4

7

8

7

CS + health engineering with clear research questions

Working prototype demonstrates technical capability

Mental health tech aligns with MIT's health interests

Formal proposal with methodology section required

No business component evaluated

Written format suits technical projects

Small scale but broader potential

International with funded travel; moderate competition

7. Gates Goalkeepers Youth

● Moonshot Medium

AI Healthcare Global Health Leadership SDG Score: 59/80 SV: V3–V5 ★★★★★~15h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: Network + visibility + global summit invitation

Deadline: ~May 2027

Stage: Working Product → Startup

Travel: Global summit travel funded

Network: Gates Foundation; global health leaders; UN partners; world leaders summit

India: Global • India eligible • Past Indian goalkeepers • Travel funded

MATERIALS

✓ Pitch ✓ Demo ✗ GitHub ✗ Paper ✗ BizPlan ✗ Prototype

JUDGING

SDG progress • Innovation • Leadership • Scalability

SOURCES

[Official](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI ✓
Healthcare ✓
Research ✗
Startup ✗
Hardware ✗
Clinical ✗

RISKS

Eligibility: Open globally; youth focus

Documentation: Application + impact story + video

Timing: Deadline ~May

Validation: Demonstrated health impact needed

Presentation: Storytelling format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation 8 AI mental health addresses SDG 3 directly
Tech Depth 6 Working product shows commitment to global health
Healthcare 10 Strongest healthcare alignment of any opportunity
Research 6 Impact evidence preferred over formal research
Business 6 Not business-focused
Pitch 8 Storytelling suits mission-driven projects
Impact 10 Global health impact is core criterion
Accessibility 5 Competitive but fully-funded
Total: 59/80

8. WHO Youth Council

● Safe Low

Healthcare Policy Advocacy Global Health Score: 56/80 SV: V3–V5 ★★★★★~3h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: Network + visibility + policy influence

Deadline: Varies (monitor announcements)

Stage: Working Product → Startup

Travel: Virtual likely; in-person events may be funded

Network: WHO; global health ministers; UN agencies; youth health leaders

India: Global • India eligible (WHO SEARO) • Open to member states

MATERIALS

✗ Pitch ✗ Demo ✗ GitHub ✗ Paper ✗ BizPlan ✗ Prototype

JUDGING

Youth leadership • Health advocacy • Innovation

SOURCES

[Official](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI ✓
Healthcare ✓
Research ✗
Startup ✗
Hardware ✗
Clinical ✗

RISKS

Eligibility: Selection can be opaque

Documentation: Expression of interest + bio

Timing: Varies; monitor WHO

Validation: Not evaluated

Presentation: Short application

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation 7 AI + mental health relevant to WHO's work
Tech Depth 6 Technical implementation less important than advocacy
Healthcare 10 Strongest healthcare alignment
Research 6 No research expectations
Business 4 No business component
Pitch 6 Short application format
Impact 9 Policy influence is primary outcome
Accessibility 8 Low barrier; no cost
Total: 56/80

9. Hackathons (MIT / Penn / MLH)

Safe

High

AI

Hackathon

Rapid Prototyping

Networking

Score: 54/80

SV: V3–V4

★★★★☆~5h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: \$1K–\$5K + swag + recruiting + API credits
Deadline: Ongoing (per event)
Stage: Prototype → Working Product
Travel: Many offer virtual tracks; some travel grants
Network: MIT, UPenn, Stanford, MLH; top tech company recruiters
India: Global • Many virtual tracks • Some offer travel grants • High school welcome

MATERIALS

✔ Pitch ✔ Demo ✔ GitHub ✖ Paper ✖ BizPlan ✔ Prototype

JUDGING

Technical complexity • Creativity • Polish • Usefulness • Presentation

SOURCES

[MLH](#) [HackMIT](#) [PennApps](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI	✔
Healthcare	✖
Research	✖
Startup	✖
Hardware	✖
Clinical	✖

RISKS

Eligibility: Most open to high school; check per event
Documentation: Working demo at end of event
Timing: 24–48 hours; apply in advance
Validation: Not evaluated
Presentation: Live demo format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation	7	Rapid prototyping to add new features
Tech Depth	8	Existing codebase enables quick iteration
Healthcare	8	Health tech projects often place well
Research	3	No research expectations
Business	5	No business model required
Pitch	7	Short demo suits working projects
Impact	6	Smaller scale but immediate feedback
Accessibility	10	Lowest barrier; high acceptance rates
Total:	54/80	

10. OpenCV AI Competition

Safe

High

AI

Computer Vision

Hardware

NVIDIA

Score: 53/80

SV: V3–V4

★★★★☆~15h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: \$6K + NVIDIA hardware + cloud credits
Deadline: ~February 2027
Stage: Working Product → Hardware
Travel: Virtual entry; no travel required
Network: OpenCV team; NVIDIA; Intel; computer vision community
India: Global • India eligible • Virtual participation • Past Indian winners

MATERIALS

✖ Pitch ✔ Demo ✔ GitHub ✖ Paper ✖ BizPlan ✔ Prototype

JUDGING

Technical complexity • Innovation • Completeness • Documentation

SOURCES

[Official](#) [Apply](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI	✔
Healthcare	✖
Research	✖
Startup	✖
Hardware	✔
Clinical	✖

RISKS

Eligibility: Open globally; no restrictions
Documentation: Code + demo video
Timing: Deadline ~Feb; needs CV feature built
Validation: Not required
Presentation: Technical demo format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation	7	Facial emotion recognition via webcam is a natural extension
Tech Depth	9	Deep learning + OpenCV skills demonstrated
Healthcare	8	Indirect health application through emotion detection
Research	5	No research paper required
Business	3	No business component
Pitch	6	Technical demo suits engineering projects
Impact	7	Niche impact within CV community
Accessibility	8	Virtual entry; good acceptance rate; free
Total:	53/80	

11. MIT PRIMES / Adventures in AI

Stretch Medium
AI Research Mentorship MIT Score: 53/80 SV: V3 ★★★★☆~10h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: Free research mentorship + MIT certificate

Deadline: ~January 2027

Stage: Research → Working Product

Travel: Virtual participation; no travel needed

Network: MIT Math Dept; MIT CSAIL; research mentors; PhD students and professors

India: Global • India eligible • Virtual • Strong math/CS background needed

MATERIALS

✗ Pitch ✗ Demo ✓ GitHub ✓ Paper ✗ BizPlan ✗ Prototype

JUDGING

Academic excellence • Research potential • Math/CS maturity

SOURCES

[Official](#) [Apply](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI ✓
Healthcare ✗
Research ✓
Startup ✗
Hardware ✗
Clinical ✗

RISKS

Eligibility: Open globally; strong academic record needed

Documentation: Application + recommendations + transcript

Timing: Deadline ~Jan; apply early

Validation: Academic excellence expected

Presentation: Interview format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation 7 ML emotion classification is a solid AI research topic
Tech Depth 9 Advanced ML pipeline with sklearn demonstrates depth
Healthcare 7 Indirect healthcare via affective computing
Research 9 Strong alignment with research program goals
Business 3 No business component
Pitch 5 Written application + interview
Impact 7 Long-term value via mentorship and publication
Accessibility 6 Virtual removes geographic barriers
Total: 53/80

12. UNESCO Youth Programmes

Safe Low
Healthcare Education Policy Youth Score: 51/80 SV: V3–V5 ★★★★☆~3h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: Network + capacity building + visibility

Deadline: Varies (multiple programmes)

Stage: Idea → Prototype → Working Product

Travel: Virtual available; some funded forums

Network: UNESCO; global education/health network; youth forums

India: Global • India eligible • UNESCO New Delhi office active

MATERIALS

✗ Pitch ✗ Demo ✗ GitHub ✗ Paper ✗ BizPlan ✗ Prototype

JUDGING

Youth engagement • Innovation for SDGs • Inclusivity

SOURCES

[Official](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI ✗
Healthcare ✓
Research ✗
Startup ✗
Hardware ✗
Clinical ✗

RISKS

Eligibility: Open globally

Documentation: Bio + project summary

Timing: Varies; monitor

Validation: Not evaluated

Presentation: Short format

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation 6 Health innovation for SDGs aligns with UNESCO
Tech Depth 5 Technical depth less important than youth engagement
Healthcare 8 SDG 3 alignment
Research 5 No research expectations
Business 4 Not business-focused
Pitch 6 Simple application
Impact 8 Broad youth development impact
Accessibility 9 Lowest barrier entry
Total: 51/80

13. UNICEF Innovation Fund

● Moonshot

Medium

AI

Healthcare

Grant

Open Source

Children

Score: 61/80

SV: V4–V5

★★★★☆~20h

OFFICIAL INFORMATION

Prize: \$100K equity-free
Deadline: Rolling (quarterly cohorts)
Stage: Working Product → Startup
Travel: Virtual application; no travel required
Network: UNICEF; global health network; government partners; open-source community
India: Global • India eligible • Open-source preference • Child wellbeing focus

MATERIALS

✔ Pitch

✔ Demo

✔ GitHub

✘ Paper

✔ BizPlan

✔ Prototype

JUDGING

Open-source readiness • Child impact • Sustainability • Team

SOURCES

[Official](#) [Apply](#) [Portfolio](#)

PROJECT FIT ANALYSIS

AI

Healthcare

Research

Startup

Hardware

Clinical

✔

✔

✘

✔

✘

✘

RISKS

Eligibility: Must open-source core components
Documentation: Grant application + budget + impact model
Timing: Rolling; quarterly cohorts
Validation: Child impact evidence needed
Presentation: Written application

SCORE JUSTIFICATION

Innovation8 AI + mental health for children is a UNICEF priority

Tech Depth7 Full-stack platform demonstrates implementation capability

Healthcare10 Direct alignment with child mental health mission

Research6 Limited research component

Business8 Business sustainability evaluated

Pitch7 Written application format

Impact10 Global scale for children’s wellbeing

Accessibility5 Equity-free but competitive; open-source prerequisite

Total: 61/80

9. Timeline

Deadline distribution and preparation periods. Rolling opportunities are always open.

Period	Deadlines	Visual	Focus
Aug'26	0		Emergent Ventures • Hackathons • India NIF/Atal • UNICEF Fund
Sep'26	3		IRIS opens • MIT THINK prep
Oct'26	0		Proposal writing
Nov'26	2		IRIS deadline • OpenCV prep
Dec'26	1		Rise deadline
Jan'27	3		MIT THINK • MIT PRIMES • IRIS finals
Feb'27	1		OpenCV deadline
Mar'27	0		Technovation prep • Hackathons
Apr'27	0		UNICEF Fund prep • Paper writing
May'27	3		Technovation • ISEF • Gates Goalkeepers
Jun–Aug'27	0		Hackathons • V4 hardware • Open-source release

ROLLING (APPLY ANYTIME)

Emergent Ventures • UNICEF Innovation Fund • Hackathons • WHO Youth Council • UNESCO Youth • India NIF/Atal

10. Glossary

Accelerator: Cohort-based program with mentorship and funding (grant or equity)

Clinical Validation: Evidence from formal studies or trials that a health intervention works

Clinical Workflow: The sequence of steps clinicians follow; Sentinel's triage + dashboard fits here

Digital Therapeutics: Evidence-based therapeutic interventions delivered via software

Edge Computing: Running AI locally on devices rather than cloud servers; core to Sentinel's future

Equity-Free: Funding that does not require giving up ownership

Human Subjects Research: Studies involving people; may require IRB approval for clinical deployment

Incubator: Longer-term program helping early ventures develop product and business model

IRB: Institutional Review Board; ethics committee that approves research with human subjects

MVP: Minimum Viable Product; simplest version to test core assumptions with real users

Non-Dilutive Funding: Money that does not require giving up equity (grants, prizes, scholarships)

Open-Source License: Legal framework for sharing code (MIT, Apache, GPL); required for UNICEF Fund

Proof of Concept: Early demonstration that an idea or technology is feasible

Seed Grant: Early-stage funding (\$5K–\$100K) to validate an idea or build an MVP

TRL: Technology Readiness Level (1–9); Sentinel is ~TRL 6 (demonstrated in relevant environment)

Validation Study: Formal process testing whether a health intervention produces measurable outcomes

11. Limitations

- Deadlines, eligibility, and prizes may change after research date. Verify official sources before applying.
- Acceptance rates are estimates based on publicly available information or historical patterns.
- Funding availability and amounts vary by year and program cycle.
- Some opportunities require manual verification of exact 2027 opening dates.
- Sentinel fit scores are project-specific and based on current platform capabilities (V3).
- Confidence ratings reflect information availability, not opportunity quality.
- Travel funding policies may vary by geographic region, financial need, or program change.
- Archived opportunities should be re-checked each cycle; policies evolve.

Disclaimer: This database was researched as of **July 30, 2026** and is not a substitute for official sources. Verify all details before applying.

Appendix A: Eligibility Matrix

Opportunity	Global	India	U18	Solo	Virtual	Travel Funded	Prototype
Emergent Ventures	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
MIT THINK	✓	✓	✓	✓	⚠	✓	✓
IRIS → ISEF Pathway	✓	✓	✓	✓	⚠	✓	✓
India NIF / Atal Innovation Mission	✓	✓	✓	✓	⚠	✗	✓
Technovation Girls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Hackathons (MIT / Penn / MLH)	✓	⚠	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
OpenCV AI Competition	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
MIT PRIMES / Adventures in AI	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
UNICEF Innovation Fund	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Rise Challenge (Schmidt Futures)	✓	✓	✓	✓	⚠	✓	✓
Gates Goalkeepers Youth	✓	✓	✓	✓	⚠	✓	✗
WHO Youth Council	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
UNESCO Youth Programmes	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗

Appendix B: Archive A — Permanently Excluded

Opportunities excluded due to inactive status, paid tuition, US-only eligibility, or premature stage. These are unlikely to become viable for Sentinel in the near term.

Opportunity	Reason	Detail
Google Science Fair	Inactive	On hiatus; no confirmed 2026–2027 cycle
MIT LaunchX	Paid	Tuition-based program
Pioneer Academics	Paid	Tuition-based program
Thiel Fellowship	Too early	Requires college dropout; premature for current stage
YC Main Track	Too early	Needs traction; revisit at V5/V6
Congressional App Challenge	US-only	Requires US citizenship
NCWIT Aspirations	US-only	Requires US citizenship
JSHS	US-only	Requires US school affiliation
Bank of America Student Leaders	US-only	Requires US citizenship
Thermo Fisher JIC	US-only	Requires US school affiliation
Youth Innovation Grant	US-only	Requires US residency

Appendix C: Archive B — Future & Conditional Opportunities

These are strong Sentinel fits but not currently actionable due to travel funding constraints, eligibility questions, or unverified status. Re-evaluate each application cycle — policies change year to year.

Opportunity	Barrier	Why Sentinel Fits	What Would Need to Change
Diamond Challenge	Self-funded travel	Startup thinking, innovation, business, impact — almost a perfect Sentinel competition	Travel funding becomes available or virtual finals option added
XTF Global	Partial travel funding	Global health innovation summit with UN partners	Full travel scholarship or virtual attendance option
Davidson Fellows	US-only policy	\$50K fellowship for significant work; Sentinel fits perfectly	Policy changes to accept international applicants
Genius Olympiad	Self-funded travel	Health/environment category; Indian students frequently medal	Travel funding secured via sponsor or school
GSEA	Self-funded travel	Student entrepreneurship competition; healthcare vertical	Sentinel generates revenue; travel funding available
Trinity Challenge	Unverified next cycle	£1M+ global health competition; mental health angle strong	Next cycle announced and verified
Davis Projects for Peace	Self-funded travel	Peace through mental health; SDG alignment	College sponsor found; travel funding confirmed

Appendix D: Scoring Formula

Each opportunity scored on 8 dimensions (1–10). Total = sum of all dimensions (max 80).

Dimension	Weight	What It Measures
Innovation	Equal	Novelty of idea and technical approach
Technical Depth	Equal	Engineering and ML sophistication
Healthcare	Equal	Mental health relevance and clinical alignment
Research	Equal	Scientific rigour and publishability
Business	Equal	Commercial viability and business model
Pitch	Equal	Presentation effectiveness for judges
Impact	Equal	Potential for real-world change at scale
Accessibility	Equal	Ease of entry: cost, location, eligibility

All dimensions weighted equally for simplicity and auditability. Score justifications provided per entry to ensure transparency.

Risk levels: Safe (high chance of medal/acceptance) | Stretch (competitive but realistic) | Moonshot (extremely selective).

Appendix E: Source Index

Opportunity	Official	Apply	Rules/FAQ	Past Winners
Emergent Ventures	Official	Apply	Info	—
MIT THINK	Official	Apply	Info	—
IRIS → ISEF Pathway	Official	—	Info	Winners
India NIF / Atal Innovation Mission	—	—	Info	—
Technovation Girls	Official	Apply	—	—
Hackathons (MIT / Penn / MLH)	Official	—	—	—
OpenCV AI Competition	Official	Apply	—	—
MIT PRIMES / Adventures in AI	Official	Apply	—	—
UNICEF Innovation Fund	Official	Apply	Info	Winners
Rise Challenge (Schmidt Futures)	Official	Apply	—	—
Gates Goalkeepers Youth	Official	—	—	—
WHO Youth Council	Official	—	—	—
UNESCO Youth Programmes	Official	—	—	—

12. Version History

Ver	Date	Changes
4.1	July 30, 2026	Editorial refinement: research funnel diagram, decision tree, tags per card, split appendix (A–E), risk categories renamed, project fit analysis label, cover redesigned as research report, reading time added, score justifications tightened, research confidence breakdown, visual timeline with deadline counts. Archive split into A (permanently excluded) and B (future/conditional) with re-evaluation notes. 13 active + 7 future entries.
4.0	July 30, 2026	Filtered to Aug 2026+ deadlines, free entry, funded/virtual travel. Removed US-only, self-funded travel, unverified. Added methodology, match matrices, confidence, risk categories, score justifications, limitations. 13 entries.
3.0	July 30, 2026	Complete redesign: cover, TOC, stats, legend, standardized cards, Gantt timeline, glossary, appendix, version history. 24 entries.
2.0	July 30, 2026	Verified entries, removed paid programs, added acceptance rates, risk levels, scoring breakdowns. 24 entries.
1.0	July 30, 2026	Initial database: 45+ opportunities, scoring, calendar, checklist.